Course Name : Communication Skills
Course Code : HS-101
Course Type : Institute Core

Contact Hours/Week: 2L **Course Credits:**02

Course Objectives

- To introduce the basic skills crucial for successful English language communication.
- To enable learners to develop a strong theoretical base for participating in and handling communicative tasks in English.
- To enable the students to communicate their perspectives in clear and correctly articulated language through LSRW skills.
- To provide ample opportunities to acquire, practice, and produce the language skills required in real-life academic and professional communication.
- To instill a lifelong habit of language learning among students to make them self-sufficient and independent learners.

Unit Number	Course Content	Contact Hours
UNIT-01	**Introduction:** Role of Effective Communication Skills for an Engineer, Challenges in Learning Language and Means to overcome them. **Communication Process:** What is communication? Process of Communication, Types of Communication (formal, semi-formal, and informal), Modes of Communication (verbal and non-verbal), Non-verbal Communication Types (Kinesics, Proxemics, Chronemics), Channels and Levels of Communication (Extrapersonal, Interpersonal, Intrapersonal, Organizational, and Mass), Barriers to Effective Communication	06L
UNIT-02	**Effective Listening Skills:** What does listening mean? Listening versus Hearing, Listening Process (hearing, understanding, remembering, evaluating, and responding), Types of Listening (appreciative, empathetic, comprehensive, critical, and superficial), Note-taking, Barriers to Listening, Strategies for Effective Listening **Effective Speaking Skills:** Interviews: Video conferencing (Google Meet, Zoom or Microsoft Teams) and Personal Interviews, Pre-interview Planning, preparing for GD in Current Topics, Strategies for Answering Interview Questions (most frequent questions and behavioral questions using STAR method) **Public Speaking:** Presenting a Variety of Speeches (informative, persuasive, demonstrative and special occasion), Extempore versus Impromptu Speech, Speech Preparation and Presentation Techniques Improving Non-verbal Cues (voice, diction, and other mechanics of speech) **SWOT Analysis:** Personal and organizational	08L
UNIT-03	**Reading Skills:** Referencing Skills: Use of traditional versus Digital Dictionaries, Note-making, Methods of Note-making (sentence, outline, mind-map, tabular/charting and Cornell) **Comprehension Skills:** Reading for Local and Global Understanding, Reading between the Lines, Summarizing the Ideas from the Reading Comprehension Passages, Reading for Evaluation, Vocabulary in Context **Reading for literary appreciation:** Reading fiction/poetry/plays and learning language through literature	06L
UNIT-04	**Writing Skills:** Paragraph Writing: Format (introduction, topic sentence, supporting details and conclusion), Genres of Writing (descriptive, narrative, expository and persuasive), Stages of Writing (brainstorming, drafting, revision, editing, proofreading and formatting) **Letter and Email Writing:** Formal versus Informal letters/emails, Letters Formats (full block, semi-block, modified block and modified semi-block), Request and permission letters and emails **Statement of Purpose (SoP):** Importance of SoP, Format, and Guidelines for Writing SoP **Cover letter and resume:** Types of Resume (chronological and functional), Latest Professional Resume Templates **Report Writing:** Importance of technical report writing, types of technical reports, Language of report writing, collection of data for report writing, interpreting results (Charts and Figures), Outline of a technical report, writing abstracts/reports.	06L

Course Outcomes

Upon successful completion of the course, the students will be able to
CO1: Identify the importance of communication skills and develop their understanding of the basic concepts related to English language skills.
CO2: Understand and analyze critically what they listen/read and respond appropriately and constructively.
CO3: Apply principles of effective LSRW skills in professional and social communication.
CO4: Understand, analyze and evaluate the verbal and non-verbal messages effectively
CO5: Acquire learning strategies to improve their communication skills after the course completion.

Textbooks

1. Technical Communication: Principles and Practice by Meenakshi Raman & Sangeeta Sharma, Oxford University Press: New Delhi.
2. English for Jobseekers: Language and soft skills for the aspiring by Lina Mukhopadhyay, Cambridge University Press: India.
3. Practical English Usage by Michael Swan. Oxford University Press: Oxford.

Reference Books

1. Strengthen your Communication Skills by Salivendra Jayaraju. Maruthu Publications: India.
2. The Definitive Book of Body Language by Allan Pease and Barbara Pease. Manjul Publishing House: New Delhi.
3. Language Through Literature: An Introduction. Paul Simpson. United Kingdom, Routledge.